Tester Guide

Chip Rack — published by Inside Craps

> **This page is for Chip Rack testers.** It describes the 1.0.0 build and includes a list of known rough edges, so it is not the documentation for the released app. Prefer a copy you can keep? Download it as a PDF.

What this is

A **record-keeping app for casino trips.** You log what you bought in for and what you walked away with, and it does the arithmetic — per session, per trip, and over time.

Think of it as replacing the notes app, the spreadsheet, or the back of the envelope most players actually use.

What this isn't

There is no gambling in this app. No wagering, no real money, no play money, no games. It doesn't connect to a casino, a sportsbook, or a payment system. It's a ledger — the gambling already happened somewhere else, and this is where you write down how it went.

Worth stating plainly, because anything in this category invites the assumption.

(The name comes from the chip rail — the grooved track around a craps table where players keep their chips. Your rack is what you brought and what you have left, which is exactly what the app keeps track of.)

Your data never leaves your phone

There's no account to create, no login, no cloud, no sync, and no analytics. Everything you log is stored in a database on your device, and if you delete the app, it's gone.

The app makes exactly **one** kind of outside connection: it checks whether a newer version of itself is available. That request carries the app's version, its release channel, whether you're on Android or iOS, the project's identifier with the update service, and a random token that tells the service whether this installation has already asked. No account, no device ID, no advertising ID, and none of what you've entered. Nothing you log ever leaves your phone. Full detail at https://inside-craps.github.io/privacy.html.

That's a deliberate design decision, not a missing feature. The trade-off: **nothing is backed up automatically.** If you want a copy, use the export in Settings (more below).

The core idea: Trips and Sessions

Two levels, and everything else hangs off them.

A Session is one sitting at one game. You record what you **bought in** for and what you **colored up** with — the app works out the profit or loss. You can also note the casino, the game, the date and time, and anything else worth remembering.

A Trip is a container for sessions. It has a starting bankroll, and it tracks your running position across every session inside it.

So: a long weekend in Vegas is one Trip. The four separate times you sat down at a craps table across those days are four Sessions.

Two kinds of Trip

Standard trips are what you'd expect — a named trip with a start and end date. "March Vegas Trip." You create one, log sessions against it, and it closes out when the dates pass.

Local Play is different and worth understanding. It's a single, permanent, never-ending bucket for your **routine play close to home** — not for one specific casino. It has no dates and never closes. The idea is that regular local play isn't really a "trip"; it's ongoing, and forcing it into trip-shaped boxes would be annoying and would distort your numbers. So it gets its own bucket, and the reports let you look at local play and travel trips separately.

You get one Local Play trip, tied to the Destination you pick during setup under **Where You Play Locally** — and you can log sessions against it at **any casino in that Area**, not just one. If you rotate between three places within reach of home, all three belong here.

The **home casino** you choose during setup is only a convenience: it pre-fills the casino field when you log a session, so the place you visit most often is already selected. You can change it on any session, and doing so doesn't reassign the trip or affect anything else.

Two numbers that look like they should match, and don't

On a trip you'll see **Take Home** and **Net P/L**. They answer different questions:

- **Net P/L** is what you won or lost.
- **Take Home** is what you'd walk away with — your starting bankroll with the Net P/L applied.

So a trip you started with $1,000 and lost $200 on shows **Net P/L −$200** and **Take Home $800**. Both are right; neither is a correction of the other. There's a line on the trip screen saying so, added after a tester reasonably read them as two attempts at the same figure.

Where you played

Three things nest: **Casinos** sit inside a **Destination**, and a Destination sits inside an **Area**.

	what it is	how many	example
Casino	the property itself	226	Bellagio
Destination	the place you'd say you were going	48	Las Vegas Strip
Area	the wider place that Destination belongs to	46	Las Vegas

For 45 of the 46 Areas, the Area and the Destination are **the same place under the same name** — *Biloxi* is an Area containing one Destination, also called *Biloxi*. So most of the time this distinction is invisible and you can ignore it.

Las Vegas is the only exception: one Area holding three Destinations — Strip, Downtown, and South Strip–Henderson. That's deliberate, because a Vegas trip realistically moves between all three. It's also why a trip lets you log a session at any casino in its **Area**, not only its Destination.

There's also a Region, which is purely a way to narrow a long list when you're choosing a Destination. There are seven: *West, South, Midwest, Mid Atlantic, Northeast, Southwest*

and *Las Vegas*. You'll meet it as the first of the two dropdowns — pick the Region, then the Destination.

> ❗ **This guide had this wrong until September 2026** and said "46 regions," which is the number of **Areas**. If you read the old version, then opened the app and found a Region dropdown with seven entries instead of forty-six — that was the guide's fault, not yours, and not a bug. The casino count was stale too.

If a casino isn't there, you can add it — Destinations tab, find the Destination, add it under that. You can also **rename** a casino or **deactivate** one you'll never use, from the casino's own screen. Anything you add or edit is yours and won't be overwritten by app updates.

You can't add a whole new Destination or Area yourself yet — only a casino within an existing one. If somewhere you play doesn't fit anywhere in the list, tell me; that's a real gap and I'd rather hear it than have you force a session into the wrong place.

The built-in list can grow. An app update can add casinos to your existing install — so if a casino appears that wasn't there last week, that's intended, not a glitch. Occasionally one may also be corrected or renamed (a few in the list still carry names the property has since changed). **Casinos you added yourself are never touched by this**, and neither is one you've renamed — an edit you made is treated as yours and left alone permanently.

If a casino you play at is missing, please tell me. That's a genuinely useful report now that the list can be updated in place, and it was the exact gap that prompted this feature: a session at a Pennsylvania casino that wasn't in the app.

⚠️ **If you add a casino and it later shows up in an update too, you'll see it twice.** The app can't safely tell that your "Hollywood Grantville" and the official "Hollywood Casino at Penn National Race Course" are the same building — and guessing wrong would be worse, since merging two casinos would move your session history onto the wrong one. So it leaves both alone and lets you decide.

This is worth fixing rather than ignoring, because until you do, your Profit/Loss by Casino report splits that one casino across two rows. Two steps, in this order:

1. **Edit any session logged at your version** and pick the official casino instead. (Open the session, change the casino, save.)

2. **Then deactivate your own entry** — Destinations tab, find it, deactivate. It disappears from the pickers, and nothing you've logged is lost.

Do it in that order; deactivating first hides the old casino while a session still points at it, which just makes the edit fiddlier. **And it's still worth telling me the casino was missing** — that's how it gets into the built-in list for everyone else.

What you can log per session

17 game types are built in: Craps, Blackjack, Baccarat, Roulette, Slots, Video Poker, Poker, Pai Gow Poker, Sic Bo, Keno, and the house-banked poker games — Three Card, Ultimate Texas Hold'em, Let It Ride, Mississippi Stud, Four Card, Casino Hold'em and Caribbean Stud.

Most have **variants** (Craps: Traditional, Crapless, Bubble, Stadium — Blackjack: 3:2, 6:5, Single Deck, Double Deck, Spanish 21, Free Bet) and many have **side bets** you can tick off (Craps: ATS, Fire Bet, Repeater, Sharpshooter, Hot Roller).

Variants are pick-one. Side bets are pick-as-many-as-apply. Both are optional.

Adding your own game types, variants or side bets isn't available yet. The built-in list is what you get for now. **So if a game, a rule variant or a side bet you actually play is missing, that's one of the more useful things you can report** — especially craps side bets, where the built-in list is deliberately short and house offerings vary a lot between properties.

(Unlike casinos, which you can add yourself, this one has no workaround. Log the session against the closest game type and tell me what was missing.)

Currency

Set in Settings. A new install now picks it from your phone's own country rather than assuming US dollars.

⚠️ **It's display formatting only — the app does not convert anything.** If you play in both the US and Canada, amounts from both are currently shown with the same symbol and added together as if they were one currency. **Per-session currency, worked out from the casino's Destination, is the real answer and it's coming after v1.** If that affects you, say so — it moved up the list because a tester raised it.

Reports

This is where the logging pays off. Everything is filterable by time period (All Time, This Year, Last Year) and by whether you want Local Play, Standard Trips, or both.

- **Bankroll Trend** — your cumulative position over time, with the highest and lowest points called out.
- **Profit/Loss by Casino** — where you actually do well, and where you don't.
- **Profit/Loss by Game Type** — same question, by game and variant.
- **Day of Week** — whether Saturdays really are worse than Tuesdays.
- **Time of Day** — Early Morning, Mid-Day, Evening, Late Night. You can adjust where those boundaries fall in Settings, since not everyone's "evening" starts at six.

Every chart drills down. Tap a bar or a row and you get the actual sessions behind that number, so a surprising figure is one tap from being explained.

The place filter here is Area, then Destination — the wider one first. That's the same two levels described above, just approached from the top instead of through a Region.

Tax report

Generates a **Win/Loss report** for your records, which you can share or save to your device as a **CSV or a PDF**.

There's a "Report Info & Limitations" screen attached to it — **please read that before judging the output.** It explains what the report does and doesn't claim to be.

It is not tax advice, and neither is this document. It organises numbers you entered; what those numbers mean for your return is between you and someone qualified.

Backup and restore

Settings → Export writes your entire database to a single file, which you can send to yourself, drop in cloud storage, or keep wherever you like. Import reads one back.

Two things to know:

Import replaces, it doesn't merge. Restoring a backup wipes what's currently in the app and puts the backup's contents in place. There's no combining two datasets.

This is your only backup. Nothing is automatic. If you're logging anything you'd be annoyed to lose, export occasionally.

Known rough edges — please don't report these

Genuinely useful to know, so you don't spend time writing up things already on the list.

> ⚠️ **Read this list as "already known," not as "don't mention it."** An earlier version of this section described partial dark mode in a way that made genuinely **unreadable** controls sound like a known cosmetic gap — and two people reported it anyway, which is the only reason it got fixed. **If something is unreadable, broken, or loses data, report it even if it looks like it belongs below.**
>
> 📱 **iPhone and Android are briefly running different code.** The iPhone beta has a batch of fixes the Android Play version hasn't received yet. They're in the next Android update. Where it matters, the platform is marked below.

Dark mode is only partly built. The Appearance setting currently affects the Trips tab only. Every other screen stays light. That's unfinished work, not a bug, and full theming comes after v1.

Appearance changes don't apply until you restart the app. Picking Dark won't visibly do anything — and the button won't even look selected — until you fully close and reopen. Known, being fixed.

One buy-in and one color-up per session. If you rebought three times, you'll need to either log separate sessions or net it out yourself. Multiple buy-ins per session is a known future addition.

You can't clear a time once you've set it. A session's End Time is optional and starts out unset, but once it has a value there's no way to empty it again — only to change it. A way to clear it is coming. *(Note that a blank Color-up, not a blank End Time, is what marks a session as still in progress, so this doesn't affect your numbers.)*

📱 **Android: the keyboard can cover the field you're typing in.** On the session form, Buy-in, Color-up, Average Bet and Table Number don't scroll clear of the keyboard, so the field you're filling can end up hidden behind it. Scroll the form up before tapping the field as a workaround. Fixed on iPhone; the Android fix is still to come.

📱 **Android Play version (1.0.0) only — five bugs are fixed but not yet released:** Reports not updating when you add or delete a session; a casino you deactivated vanishing from sessions and trips that pointed at it; the Destinations list jumping backwards while you scroll; a deactivated casino coming back every time you restart the app; and cancelling out of a date or time picker setting a value anyway. All five are fixed and ship in the next Android update. **Please do still report anything else.**

✅ **Fixed and worth re-checking if you reported one of these:** the unreadable dropdowns in dark mode; the app jumping back to the Trips tab when you fold or unfold a folding phone; and the session date defaulting to today on a trip with different dates.

What's genuinely useful to report

Anything that **crashes, loses data, or shows a wrong number.** Those three matter most, in that order.

After that: anything confusing. If you couldn't work out how to do something, that's a real finding — the app being obvious is a feature, and "I gave up looking for it" is exactly the report that's hard to get any other way.

Screenshots help enormously.

- **On iPhone**, take a screenshot while the app is open and TestFlight will offer to send it straight to me with a note attached. That's by far the easiest route, and the note comes through with the build details already filled in.
- **On Android** there's no equivalent, so just text or email them.

Either way, please mention which screen you were on.

Please include the version. Settings tab → About, at the bottom — it shows the version, build number and update ID. Paste that into any report. It matters more than it looks: two people can be running the same version number and different code, and **the update ID is the only line that tells those two apart.**

Will it run on my phone?

Android 7.0 or later, or **iOS 15.1 or later** (iPhone 6s and newer). Both are old enough that almost any phone still in use clears them — if yours doesn't, it's likely too old to install from the app stores at all.

Chip Rack is portrait-only and built for phones. It runs on an Android tablet, but the layout isn't designed for one, and iPad isn't supported.

Getting started, in about a minute

1. Open the app. It walks you through a short setup — pick **where you play locally** and your usual casino, and optionally a default game and starting bankroll.
2. That creates your **Local Play** trip automatically.
3. Log a session against it: Trips tab → your Local Play trip → **+ Log Session**.
4. Or create a real trip: Trips tab → **+ New Trip**, give it dates and a starting bankroll.
5. Once you've got a few sessions in, the **Reports** tab starts being interesting.

Feel free to enter fake data to poke around — it's your phone, and you can export first or uninstall and start over whenever you want.

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